

want to live and ask if they offer mortgages under the Community Reinvestment Act. The CRA was created by Congress to help people with relatively low incomes to buy homes. Depending upon how much you make, it may have a good deal for you. Be sure to ask, since banks usually don't advertise this program.

- **Get assistance from the Department of Veterans Affairs.**

If you've ever been in active duty in the U.S. military for at least 181 continuous days, or have served at least six years in the Selected Reserves or the National Guard, you may be eligible for a Veterans Affairs (VA) mortgage. Requirements vary depending upon when you served and if it was during wartime. You can get these VA mortgages from regular lenders.

VA loans generally do not require any down payment at all if your loan doesn't exceed \$417,000 (although this figure varies in different parts of the country), but in some cases the individual lender that supplies the VA loan may require one. The way it works: You pay a one-time charge called a **funding fee**, which is basically an upfront payment of your mortgage insurance. As of 2009, the funding fee ranged from 1.25% to 3.3% of the mortgage, depending on the terms of your loan. If you *are* able to come up with a down payment, the funding fee will be lower. There are no maximum income limits for applicants. For more information go to www.homeloans.va.gov or call 800-827-3702.

STATE HOUSING AGENCIES

State	Website	Phone Number
Alabama	ahfa.com	800-325-2432
Alaska	www.ahfc.state.ak.us	800-478-2432
Arizona	www.housingaz.com	602-771-1000